

## Statement of Purpose

Master of Science in Accounting and Finance  
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Oman's renewable-energy transition is not only a technical deployment problem. It is a project-finance, disclosure, and capital-market problem. A solar or wind asset may fit a national energy target, carry a green label, and attract Shariah-sensitive investors, yet still fail as infrastructure finance if its cash flows cannot absorb CAPEX stress, profit-rate pressure, tariff uncertainty, curtailment, disclosure cost, or debt-service volatility. My proposed research therefore begins from a narrow question: under what conditions can green sukuk finance utility-scale renewable-energy infrastructure in Oman while preserving bankability, ESG credibility, and Shariah-compliant capital-market discipline?

I am applying to the MSc in Accounting and Finance at Sultan Qaboos University because I want to develop this question inside a finance programme that is close to Oman's economic transformation and rigorous enough to test the instrument rather than celebrate it. My objective is to build a project-level framework that combines discounted cash-flow modelling, WACC and DSCR analysis, LCOE estimation, sukuk-versus-debt comparison, ESG scorecard design, avoided-emissions accounting, and sensitivity testing. The expected output is not a promotional argument for green sukuk. It is a decision framework that shows when green sukuk strengthen renewable-energy project finance and when they mainly add documentation cost without improving economics.

My academic path has moved steadily toward this problem. I completed a Bachelor's degree in Management, Finance and Accounting at the Université Internationale de Casablanca, graduating with high honors, and I am currently pursuing MSc-level coursework in Procurement and Supply Chain Management at INSEEC Business School in Lyon. This background gave me a hybrid profile: financial modelling, cost analysis, procurement logic, operational performance, and data-driven investment appraisal. I have not approached finance as a purely accounting exercise. I have treated it as a decision system: how capital is allocated, how assumptions are defended, and how models remain usable when the evidence is imperfect.

My first substantial research project was my final-year thesis on the financial profitability of outdoor advertising infrastructure in Casablanca. The problem was concrete: advertising operators often decide where to place static OOH or digital DOOH assets using fragmented judgments about traffic, visibility, location prestige, and expected revenue. I wanted to test whether investment decisions could be made more systematic by integrating traffic exposure, socio-economic indicators, regulatory constraints, CAPEX, OPEX, taxes, maintenance, and revenue assumptions. I used SUMO traffic simulation, GIS mapping, demographic and economic proxies, and five-year financial modelling to construct a Potential Profitability Index for comparing advertising locations.

The project taught me the discipline of translating messy urban information into an investment model. High-traffic and high-income districts did show stronger potential, but the results were conditional rather than automatic. Digital billboards appeared attractive only when their higher upfront cost could be offset by content flexibility, slot monetisation, and regulatory compliance. This was my first exposure to the core logic that now drives my SQU proposal: a visible opportunity is not automatically a bankable asset. The model must survive cost structure, cash-flow timing, operational risk, regulation, and sensitivity testing.

The same project also revealed a limitation. ROI-based models can rank locations, but they do not fully explain uncertainty, externalities, or long-term resilience. That limitation pushed me toward a broader independent research paper: AI-MCDM Investment Scoring for Smart Cities under Carbon, Energy, and Geoeconomic Risk. In that work, I designed an AI-enabled multi-criteria decision-analysis scorecard for ranking smart-city infrastructure projects under energy-price, carbon-cost, and geoeconomic uncertainty. The framework combined XGBoost-based demand forecasting, carbon-adjusted Decoupled Net Present Value, Real Options reasoning, Fuzzy-AHP/MEREC weighting, and AROMAN ranking. I benchmarked the model against World Bank, EIB, WDI, and ESG datasets and tested whether multi-criteria infrastructure rankings diverged from NPV-only rankings.

That project gave me two important outcomes. First, XGBoost reduced mean absolute error by 45.8 percent relative to Ridge regression in the original temporal validation, while the AROMAN scorecard produced rankings that diverged from NPV-only ordering across all 25 projects. Second, and more important intellectually, the model did

not confirm every hypothesis. Geoeconomic risk was not supported at the full-panel level, and early AROMAN implementations produced unstable rankings. I corrected the normalization logic, separated prediction from ranking, distinguished predictive contribution from causal interpretation, and learned to treat negative results as methodological information rather than as failure. This experience was a decisive research obstacle: it forced me to become less attached to model complexity and more committed to auditability, robustness, and transparent downgrade rules.

That lesson directly shapes my proposed research at Sultan Qaboos University. Green sukuk are often discussed through legitimacy, market development, Shariah compliance, or sustainability branding. Renewable-energy finance is often assessed through DCF, WACC, LCOE, DSCR, and scenario analysis. ESG accounting is often treated through disclosure frameworks, avoided-emissions logic, and reporting standards. My research gap is that these three literatures often remain separate. Oman is precisely the context where they need to be tested together. A green sukuk for renewable infrastructure is credible only if the underlying asset is bankable, the ESG claim is auditable, and the financing structure improves or at least justifies its effect on cost of capital, tenor, investor base, risk allocation, and reporting burden.

My proposed methodology has five components. First, I will build a DCF model for a representative utility-scale solar PV or onshore wind project in Oman, estimating NPV, IRR, payback, LCOE, and DSCR under base, conservative, and transition-accelerated scenarios. Second, I will compare green sukuk with conventional debt through profit rate, tenor, issuance cost, use-of-proceeds control, reporting obligations, liquidity, and investor-base effects. Third, I will construct an ESG scorecard aligned with climate-disclosure logic and avoided-emissions discipline, focusing on baseline selection, grid-emission factor, project boundary, renewable output, local value, use-of-proceeds traceability, Shariah governance, and external assurance. Fourth, I will run sensitivity tests on financing cost, CAPEX, OPEX, tariff or PPA revenue, capacity factor, carbon value, and exchange-rate assumptions. Fifth, I will use expert validation or document-analysis fallback to challenge the assumptions before they become conclusions.

This design is intentionally falsifiable. If the model shows that green sukuk reduce WACC under certain scenarios, the study will specify the conditions. If the effect is neutral or negative after fees, disclosure burden, or liquidity constraints, the study will state that plainly. In that case, the value of green sukuk may lie less in cheaper capital and more in investor-base diversification, Shariah alignment, traceability, and governance discipline. A credible research project must allow that result. It must not assume that the instrument succeeds before the model has tested it.

Sultan Qaboos University is the right environment for this work because the MSc in Accounting and Finance combines coursework and thesis training within the College of Economics and Political Science, with Finance and Accounting as formal majors and instruction in English. The programme structure matches the skills I need to refine: advanced finance, accounting analysis, research methods, financial econometrics, Islamic finance, and thesis-level empirical discipline. I already have practical exposure to Excel, VBA, Power Query, Power BI, QGIS, SUMO, financial modelling, and introductory Python. What I need now is deeper training in financial econometrics, capital-market analysis, Islamic finance structures, sustainability accounting, and thesis supervision in Oman's institutional context.

The faculty fit is specific. Dr. Syed Mujahid Hussain's work on price discovery, financial markets, market microstructure, emerging markets, financial integration, and Islamic finance aligns with the capital-market side of my project: how sukuk pricing, liquidity, and investor-base effects should be interpreted rather than assumed. Dr. B. Tas's interests in financial econometrics, public procurement, machine-learning applications in economics and finance, and quantitative methods connect directly to my need to strengthen sensitivity testing, scenario modelling, and the empirical discipline behind my investment framework. Dr. Nisar Ahmad's expertise in econometrics, spatial econometrics, labour economics, and regional economics is relevant to the spatial and regional dimensions of my earlier work and to any extension of the project toward local value, regional infrastructure impacts, or location-specific renewable-energy deployment. I do not see SQU simply as a place to obtain a degree. I see it as the institutional setting where my existing applied models can be disciplined into a thesis that is locally relevant, technically defensible, and useful for Oman's capital-allocation challenges.

My professional experience reinforces this direction. At 2ACOM, I worked on OOH/DOOH financial modelling and zone-level profitability prioritisation, which gave me direct exposure to CAPEX, OPEX, TCO, break-even

logic, and revenue assumptions. At MAGHREBAIL, I worked with financial performance and credit-risk reporting across corporate client portfolios, which strengthened my understanding of risk exposure and reporting reliability. At SAN MAROC, I worked on recovery portfolio segmentation, dashboards, DSO, recovery rates, and reporting automation using VBA and Power Query. These experiences did not replace academic research, but they made one principle clear: models matter only when they can guide decisions under operational constraints.

My long-term goal is to build an international career at the intersection of project finance, Islamic capital markets, sustainable infrastructure, and data-driven investment governance. Over the next five to ten years, I want to work on infrastructure investment appraisal for renewable energy, logistics, water, transport, and smart-city systems in the MENA region. I aim to contribute to institutions that must decide not only whether projects are attractive, but whether they are financially resilient, disclosure-ready, climate-aligned, and governed well enough to attract long-term capital. Oman is an appropriate starting point because its Vision 2040 agenda, renewable-energy targets, sustainable-finance developments, logistics ambitions, and emerging green-sukuk market create a real laboratory for this type of research.

The MSc in Accounting and Finance at Sultan Qaboos University would allow me to convert my current profile into a more rigorous research platform. I bring a foundation in finance and accounting, applied experience in traffic-based profitability modelling, a tested interest in AI-MCDM infrastructure scoring, and a clear research proposal on green sukuk for renewable-energy infrastructure in Oman. I now seek the academic structure, faculty supervision, and methodological depth required to make that work stronger. My purpose is not to add another descriptive study of green finance. It is to build a project-level test of when sustainable Islamic finance becomes real infrastructure finance and when the label fails to survive the numbers.